

01. Introduction

Cancer prevention refers to actions that reduce the risk of developing cancer. Although not all cancers can be prevented, many cases are linked to lifestyle and environmental factors that can be modified.

Adopting healthy habits and participating in regular screening programs can significantly lower cancer risk.

02. Importance of Cancer Prevention

Cancer prevention helps to:

- Reduce the risk of developing cancer
- Detect cancer at an early stage
- Improve survival rates
- Lower healthcare costs
- Improve quality of life
- Reduce complications associated with advanced cancer

Healthy lifestyle choices benefit overall physical and mental health.

03. Avoid Tobacco Use

Tobacco is the leading preventable cause of cancer.

Smoking increases the risk of:

- Lung cancer
- Mouth cancer
- Throat cancer
- Esophageal cancer
- Bladder cancer
- Kidney cancer
- Pancreatic cancer

Secondhand smoke also increases cancer risk.

Prevention Tips

- Never start smoking.
- Quit smoking as early as possible.
- Avoid exposure to secondhand smoke.

- Seek professional help if needed.
-

04. Limit Alcohol Consumption

Excessive alcohol intake increases the risk of several cancers.

These include:

- Liver cancer
- Breast cancer
- Mouth cancer
- Throat cancer
- Esophageal cancer
- Colorectal cancer

Recommendations

- Avoid alcohol whenever possible.
 - If consumed, drink only in moderation according to medical advice.
-

05. Maintain a Healthy Diet

A nutritious diet lowers cancer risk.

Include:

- Fresh fruits
- Green leafy vegetables
- Whole grains
- Legumes
- Nuts
- Lean proteins
- Healthy fats

Limit:

- Processed foods
- Processed meat
- Sugary beverages
- Excess salt
- Fried foods

06. Maintain a Healthy Body Weight

Being overweight or obese increases the risk of several cancers.

Examples include:

- **Breast cancer**
- **Colorectal cancer**
- **Endometrial cancer**
- **Kidney cancer**
- **Liver cancer**

Healthy weight management involves:

- **Balanced nutrition**
- **Regular exercise**
- **Portion control**

07. Regular Physical Activity

Exercise reduces cancer risk and improves overall health.

Adults should aim for:

- **At least 150 minutes of moderate exercise each week**

Examples include:

- **Walking**
- **Cycling**
- **Swimming**
- **Jogging**
- **Yoga**
- **Dancing**

Benefits include:

- **Better immunity**
 - **Weight control**
 - **Improved mental health**
 - **Lower inflammation**
-

08. Protect Yourself from Sun Exposure

Ultraviolet (UV) radiation increases the risk of skin cancer.

Prevention

- **Wear sunscreen with SPF 30 or higher.**
 - **Wear protective clothing.**
 - **Use hats and sunglasses.**
 - **Avoid direct sunlight between 10 AM and 4 PM.**
 - **Avoid tanning beds.**
-

09. Get Vaccinated

Certain infections increase cancer risk.

Recommended vaccines include:

Human Papillomavirus (HPV) Vaccine

Helps prevent:

- **Cervical cancer**
- **Anal cancer**
- **Penile cancer**
- **Throat cancer**

Hepatitis B Vaccine

Reduces the risk of liver cancer.

Vaccination is an effective preventive measure.

10. Prevent Infections

Some infections contribute to cancer development.

Reduce infection risk by:

- **Practicing good hygiene**
 - **Safe sexual practices**
 - **Using sterile needles**
 - **Receiving recommended vaccinations**
 - **Seeking early treatment for chronic infections**
-

11. Avoid Harmful Chemicals

Exposure to harmful chemicals may increase cancer risk.

Examples include:

- Asbestos
- Benzene
- Industrial chemicals
- Certain pesticides

Prevention

- Wear protective equipment.
 - Follow workplace safety guidelines.
 - Avoid unnecessary chemical exposure.
-

12. Participate in Cancer Screening

Regular screening detects cancer before symptoms appear.

Common screening tests include:

Breast Cancer

- Mammography

Cervical Cancer

- Pap smear
- HPV testing

Colorectal Cancer

- Stool tests
- Colonoscopy

Prostate Cancer

- PSA blood test (for selected individuals)

Early detection improves treatment success.

13. Know Your Family History

Some cancers have a genetic component.

Discuss family history with healthcare providers if close relatives have had:

- Breast cancer

- Ovarian cancer
- Colon cancer
- Prostate cancer

Individuals at higher risk may benefit from earlier screening.

14. Manage Stress

Chronic stress affects overall health.

Healthy stress management includes:

- Meditation
- Yoga
- Deep breathing exercises
- Spending time with family
- Hobbies
- Counseling when needed

Good mental health supports overall well-being.

15. Get Adequate Sleep

Adults should aim for:

- 7–9 hours of quality sleep each night

Good sleep supports:

- Immune function
 - Hormonal balance
 - Mental health
 - Physical recovery
-

16. Avoid Self-Medication

Do not use medications or supplements without medical advice.

Some substances may:

- Interfere with treatment
- Cause harmful side effects
- Delay diagnosis

Always consult healthcare professionals before taking new medicines or supplements.

17. Regular Health Check-Ups

Routine medical examinations help detect health problems early.

Regular check-ups may include:

- **Blood pressure measurement**
- **Blood sugar testing**
- **Cancer screening**
- **Physical examination**
- **Laboratory tests**

Early detection often leads to better outcomes.

18. Healthy Daily Habits

Maintain healthy habits such as:

- **Eating balanced meals**
- **Drinking adequate water**
- **Exercising regularly**
- **Avoiding tobacco**
- **Limiting alcohol**
- **Managing stress**
- **Maintaining personal hygiene**

These habits reduce cancer risk and improve overall health.

19. Community Awareness

Cancer awareness programs encourage:

- **Early symptom recognition**
- **Participation in screening**
- **Vaccination**
- **Healthy lifestyle choices**
- **Timely medical consultation**

Public awareness plays an important role in cancer prevention.

20. Key Points

- Many cancers can be prevented through healthy lifestyle choices.
- Avoiding tobacco significantly reduces cancer risk.
- Healthy eating and regular exercise promote overall health.
- Vaccination protects against certain cancer-causing infections.
- Regular screening detects cancer at an early stage.
- Maintaining a healthy weight lowers the risk of several cancers.
- Protecting skin from excessive sunlight helps prevent skin cancer.
- Regular medical check-ups improve early diagnosis and treatment outcomes.